

What do we mean by
Hyper-local Materials?

Finding regenerative and
restorative supply chains
within our region, reducing
the span and impact of our
environmental footprint
while intentionally slowing
down extraction to careful
and meaningful actions .

Land Acknowledgement:

This project takes place
on Mohican land, between
the Mahicannituck (river
that flows two ways) and
Taghkanic mountain range.

Hyper-Local Robotic Entanglements
is a project led by FSD.TEMP
that explores the design and
implementation of a DIY backyard
robot to build with natural materials
gathered from local sources. HLRE
explores how to encourage the
tangibility of emerging technologies
through public engagement and
physical artifacts.

FSD.TEMP Team

Julian Goldman
Claire Moriarty
Dierdre Shea
Riley Studebaker

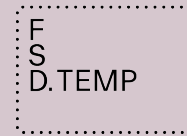
with contributions from:
Megan Green
Allison Mease

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Instagram: @funstuffdesign
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Github
Repository



Hyper-Local Materials

Identifying local material potential
in our regional ecosystem and finding
opportunities for responsible and
regenerative harvesting, production,
and building.



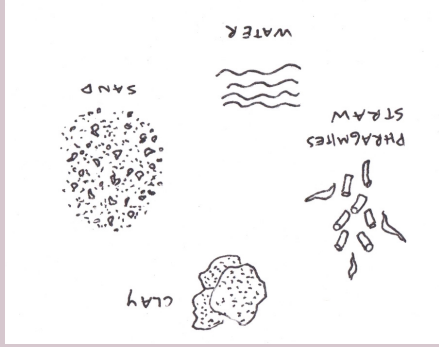
Hyper-Local
Robotic Entanglements
FSD.TEMP

2025-2026



Material Economies

Making Mudbrick:



Our region sits between the east bank of the Hudson River and the peaks of the Taconic Ridge. We are in a humid continental climate, which means that we have four distinct seasons through which temperature, precipitation, and humidity vary significantly. Material questions include: Will the material withstand the weather? When is the appropriate time to harvest material? Does it need to cure, ferment, or dry?



Seen today primarily in dry desert climates, mudbricks and mud material have been used in building across many types of climates for thousands of years. We used a mix of local clay, sand, and a straw binder made from abundant and fast-spreading monoscapes of phragmites australis. Workshop participants brought their own straw replacement, including milkweed seed, knotweed, and dandelion. We dried the bricks for about 2 weeks before building and finished them in a slaked lime-wash coating for water resistance.

Recipe:
1 part glacial clay from local pit mine
4 part sand
1/2 part phragmites (or equivalent), dried, cut to size.



Material Considerations
Strength As we lay the material on itself, the material should withstand weight and pressure.
Plasticity Mud must be worked and dried without significant cracking, slumping, or crumbling.
Source Material should be sourced within a certain proximity, supporting local economies and slower extraction practices, reducing footprint and ecological impact.

Mud brick + Backyard Bot

